

Official Carrom Rules & Regulations

International Carrom Federation (ICF)

This online edition presents the **ICF Laws of Carrom** in readable chapters. Each chapter keeps the official wording; **Beginner's guide** callouts explain how those laws work in everyday play.

New to carrom?

Carrom is finger billiards on a square wooden board. Two players (singles) or four (doubles) use a **striker** to pocket **carrommen** — nine white, nine black, and one red **Queen** — into corner pockets. You sit opposite your opponent, shoot only from your base rectangle, and take turns until one player clears all of their colour.

Under ICF rules, colours are fixed before the break (the breaker plays white). In casual games, the first piece pocketed often decides your colour — see Chapter 4. Tournament scoring is **25 points per game**, best of three games — not the informal 29-point house rules sometimes used at home.

Original sources

- [ICF Official Rules \(PDF\)](#) — authoritative laws used in this book
- [wikiHow — Play Carrom for Beginners](#) — plain-language setup, play, and scoring; beginner callouts here draw on this guide where it aligns with ICF law

Chapter 1 — Equipment

Every tournament begins with the equipment. This chapter sets out the exact specifications for the coins, the striker, the table on which the board sits, the chair the player sits on, the powder used to keep the surface smooth, the nets that catch pocketed coins, and the light overhead.

Beginner's guide — the board and pieces

A standard board has **four corner pockets** (each with a net), **foul lines** along the sides, a **centre circle** for the Queen, and a larger **outer circle** where coins are arranged for the break. Each player has a rectangular **base** at their end of the board — the striker must be placed there before every shot.

The set is **9 white, 9 black, 1 red Queen**, plus two strikers (one per player). White and black pieces are smooth wooden discs; the Queen is red. You use the striker to flick your pieces into the pockets — never

push it.

Carrommen

Diameter

Not more than **3.18 cm** and not less than **3.02 cm**.

Thickness

Between **0.70 cm** and **0.90 cm**.

Weight

Between **5.25 g** and **5.50 g**.

Set

9 white, 9 black, 1 red — all uniform.

The Carrommen used in play shall be of good quality wood and circular in shape. The edge shall be round and plain. The Carrommen shall have a smooth movement in a flat position on the playing surface of the Carrom Board when struck by a striker of standard specifications.

Striker

Diameter

Not more than **4.13 cm**.

Weight

Not more than **15.00 g**.

Material

Anything except ivory and metal. Strikers with visible metal fixed to them are not allowed.

The Striker shall be smooth and round. Engraved decent designs on the Striker are permissible.

Stand or Table

The Stand or Table on which the Carrom Board is placed for play shall not be less than **63.00 cm** and not more than **70.00 cm** in height. The Carrom Board, when placed on it, shall not be uneven or shaky.

Padding below the Carrom Board and/or the Table or Stand on which the Carrom Board is placed may be used to make the playing surface level and firm as far as possible.

Stool or Chair

The Stool or Chair on which the player sits for playing shall not be less than **40.00 cm** and not more than **50.00 cm** in height. The Chair, if used, shall be armless.

Powder

The powder used shall be of high quality to keep the playing surface smooth and dry. The powder shall not be wet. Pouches or containers filled with powder shall be used to spread the powder evenly over the playing surface.

Nets

The pockets shall be fully covered from beneath by nets fixed at the bottom of the Carrom Board. Each net shall have the capacity of holding at least **10 c/m**.

Light

The light shall be hung or fitted at a convenient height above the Carrom Board so that, when a conical or square shade — preferably of metal — is used, the light shall fall only on the Carrom Board including the frame. The shade shall be one with the inner side completely snow-white in colour. The bulb used, preferably transparent white, shall be **between 60 and 100 watts**.

Player accommodation

The height of the light can be altered at the request of a player so that the naked light does not strike their eyes.

Chapter 2 — Definitions and Terminology

In these Laws, unless there is anything repugnant to the subject or context, the terms given below shall have

the following interpretations. Read this chapter once and the rest of the Laws read naturally.

Laws and the Carrom Board

Laws

The Laws of Carrom.

Proper

In accordance with the Laws.

Improper

Contrary to the Laws.

C/B

Carrom Board.

C/m

Carromman or Carrommen.

Match Structure

Board

From the commencement of a board, after Umpire calls *Play*, till its completion on pocketing of the last

C/m of any player.

Break

The first stroke of a board.

Finish

The completion of the board.

Player

A Carrom player.

Turn

The right to strike.

The Queen, Coins, and Placing

Queen

The red C/m.

Placing

Keeping a penalty and/or due C/m in a flat position on the playing surface, within the outer circle only, by the player permitted to do so. The Queen and any jumped c/m are always placed by the umpire in the Centre Circle.

Pocketing

Putting a C/m or Queen into a pocket by a proper or improper stroke.

Covering

Pocketing one of his own C/m by a player in the same or immediately subsequent stroke after the Queen is pocketed.

Dues, Penalties and Faults

Due

Pocketing the Striker with or without C/m and/or Queen, and/or any outstanding c/m against the player as the case may be.

Penalty

Punishment for infringement or violation of the Laws.

Push

A jerk or sudden motion of the elbow of the playing hand instead of striking the Striker with the finger. Not permitted.

Strokes and Shots

Stroke

Hitting the C/m by the Striker, directly or indirectly.

Shot

A pair or cannon.

Pair

Two C/m, or one C/m and Queen, facing the general direction of the pocket with a space in between them.

Cannon

Two C/m, or one C/m and Queen, facing the general direction of the pocket *without* any space in between them.

Thumbing

Taking a stroke with the thumb.

Officials and Opponents

Chief Referee

An official appointed to administrate, supervise, control and give decisions on all matters referred to him in the course of a match.

Umpire

An official appointed to supervise and/or control a match.

Opponent (singles)

The player presently not having his turn to play.

Opponent (doubles)

The player sitting on the left and/or right side of the player presently having his turn to play.

Anatomy and Lines

Hand

The portion of the playing hand from the fingers up to the wrist.

Finger

The portion of the nail side of a finger up to the second joint.

Imaginary Lines

The lines drawn in extension of the arrows between the Base Circles.

The Slam

White Slam

Pocketing all nine white C/m and the Queen as per the Laws in the first turn of play. Also called *Break to*

Finish.

Black Slam

Pocketing all the remaining black C/m, with or without the Queen, as per the Laws in the first turn of play.

Reading note

Words implying singular shall include plural, and words implying masculine shall refer to the feminine also.

Chapter 3 — Match Setup and Play

Before the first stroke of any match, the players take their seats, the toss is held, and each player or pair is given two trial boards. This chapter covers everything that happens between the umpire's first announcement and the moment the Break is called.

Sitting Position

27. In **singles**, the players shall sit opposite to each other.

28. In **doubles**, the partners shall sit opposite to each other, occupying all four sides.

29. Position adopted for sitting by a player before taking his turn to strike may be changed at any time, provided the chair or stool on which he is sitting is not lifted, moved and/or disturbed during his turn of play.

30. a) During the board no part of the body of a player, except the playing arm, shall touch the Carrom Board, stand or table on which the C/B is placed.

b) However, wearing or clothing, ring, bangles and/or watch worn by a player are exempted during his turn of play, but these should not touch the playing surface.

31. Use of any material to raise and/or adjust the height of the seat is permissible after the completion of the board only, provided the height of the seat so raised does not exceed **50 cm**.

32. No part of the body, except the hand of the player, shall go beyond the imaginary lines of the arrows.

Beginner's guide — sitting and striking

In singles, sit **directly opposite** your opponent. In doubles, partners sit opposite each other so all four sides of the board are used. Keep your chair still during your turn — only your playing arm may reach over the board.

Rest the striker in your base rectangle before each shot. The striker must be **flicked**, not pushed. Most beginners use a **straight grip** (palm down, index finger behind the striker). A **scissors grip** (side-on, middle finger snapping forward) is also legal if you find it more comfortable — see Rules 34–38 for elbow and body limits.

How to Strike

The fundamental rule

The Striker shall be **struck** and not **pushed**.

34. The stroke shall be made with the finger with or without the support of other fingers.
35. Any hand may be used in play.
36. While making a stroke, the hand may touch the playing surface.
37. a) While making a stroke, the elbow of the playing hand shall not come within the playing surface nor shall extend beyond the imaginary lines of the arrow.
- b) The hand may, however, cross the arrow.
38. a) While making a stroke, taking support of the Stool or Chair, Stand or Table of the C/B and/or keeping the legs on the rim of the stand or table, by the player, is not permissible.
- b) However, hands may rest on his body and legs may rest on the rim of the stool or chair on which he sits.

Toss

39. a) There shall be a toss by the Umpire at the commencement of each match. The toss shall be by spin of coin or by means of calling the C/m. The player or pair winning the toss shall have the **choice of side** or the **option to strike first**. If the winner decides to have the choice of side, he shall communicate the same to the Umpire, who shall instruct the loser to sit first.
- b) In doubles, the pair winning the toss shall have the option as above.
- c) If break is chosen by the winner of the toss, the choice of side shall lie with the loser, and the winner shall have to sit first.
- d) Once the losers have sat down, they cannot interchange. This order of sitting shall continue throughout the match.

Trial Board

40. There shall be **two trial boards only** after the toss and before the start of the match — one for each player or pair.

Chapter 4 — The Break and Turn of Play

Every board begins with the Break — the opening shot that scatters the cluster of 19 coins. This chapter covers how the coins are arranged, who takes the Break, what counts as a valid Break, and how turns alternate through the rest of the board, the game, and the match.

Beginner's guide — setting up the break

Place the **Queen in the centre circle**. Arrange the other 18 coins in two compact rings around her, **alternating black and white**, all touching each other inside the outer circle. ICF Law also specifies a **"Y"** of **three white coins** in the second row — see Rule 41.

The player who breaks plays **white** for that board; the opponent has black. After the umpire calls *Play*, the breaker has **15 seconds** to strike. In casual play, a coin toss decides who breaks first; turns continue as long as you pocket your own coins.

Arranging the Coins for the Break

41. a) Before the break, the C/m are so arranged, in a flat position, that the **Queen shall occupy the Centre Circle** and the rest of the C/m are placed around the Queen in the first row, keeping the Black and White C/m alternately.

In the second row, three white C/m form the shape "Y", with the white C/m in the first row. The remaining space is filled by placing black and white C/m alternately. All c/m so arranged should be in compact round, touching each other, within the Outer Circle. A player may use his fingers or striker to keep the C/m intact.

b) The C/m should be arranged for the break with least possible loss of time after each board.

Who Breaks

42. The Break is taken by the player who has chosen to strike first.

43. The player who is to break shall have the **white C/m** during that board, leaving the black C/m to his opponent. The Queen shall be the common C/m.

What Counts as a Break

44. Break is considered to have been made if the Striker touches any of the C/m, even slightly.

45. a) Break is **not** considered made if no C/m is touched by the Striker in its usual run or jumping out. A maximum of **two more chances** shall be allowed.

b) If after the permissible number of chances no C/m is touched, the right to Break shall be lost. The turn passes on to the opponent, who will have black C/m for play. No re-arrangement of the C/m shall be permitted. This condition prevails until the break is affected.

c) If a player in his attempt to break plays an improper stroke or pockets his striker without touching any of the c/m, he loses his turn. However, a Due or penalty shall **not** be applicable.

When the Break Begins

46. The break shall be taken only after the Umpire calls **Play**, and the stroke shall be made within **15 seconds** of such call. The play is deemed to have begun from the moment the Umpire calls *Play*.

Don't jump the gun

If the break is made *before* the Umpire calls Play, all C/m and/or Queen pocketed shall be taken out for placing and a foul declared. The player loses his turn.

Turn of Play

48. As long as a player pockets his own C/m and/or Queen in accordance with the Laws, his turn shall continue. Otherwise it passes on to the opponent.

49. a) The order of Breaking across the games:

- **First game** — the player who chose to break the first board shall have the white C/m. The turn to break passes alternately during the game.
- **Second game** — the player who did not have the first turn to break in the first game shall have his turn first.
- **Third game** — the turn to break passes on to the first player.

b) In doubles, the turn passes on to the player sitting to the **right hand side** of the player who had his turn.

50. A player shall not take more than **15 seconds** for making a stroke. The timer starts the moment the C/m, Queen or Striker has come to rest and the striker is picked up by the opponent, or after observing the time limit for placing C/m and/or foregoing due or penalty C/m, if any.

51. If the turn is availed by a player who plays **out of turn**, before the Umpire could control, he loses the

board by the number of C/m and Queen as were on the C/B at the time of the first out-of-turn stroke. If the above remains unnoticed by the Umpire or opponent till the next stroke is taken, the turn shall be allowed and the next turn shall be as per the Laws.

Chapter 5 — Scoring and Change of Sides

Carrom is played in matches of three games. Each game is a sequence of boards. Each board is worth points, and the first to 25 points (or whoever leads after eight boards) wins the game. This chapter is the scorekeeping reference.

Beginner's guide — how scoring works

When you clear all your coins first, you **win the board**. Your points for that board equal the number of your opponent's coins still on the board (each worth **1 point**). If you also pocketed and **covered** the Queen while winning the board, add **3 more points** — but only while your running total in the game is **21 or below** (Rule 54).

A full **game** is won at **25 points** or after **eight boards**, whichever comes first. A **match** is best of three games. Informal guides sometimes play to 29 points; tournament and ICF play use 25.

Point Values

Coin

Points

Each C/m **1 point**

Queen **3 points** (*up to and including 21 points only*)

52. a) The player who completes pocketing all his C/m first **wins the board**.
53. a) The number of C/m of the opponent on the C/B shall be the points gained by that player in that board.
- b) The player is entitled to be credited with the value of the Queen, **only if he wins the board**.
- c) The player who loses the board is not credited with the value of the Queen, even if he has pocketed and covered the Queen.

Queen threshold

The player loses the advantage of getting the credit of an additional 3 points for covering the Queen once he has reached a score of **22 points** (Rule 54).

55. The maximum number of points that can be scored in a board is **12** only. Any Due and/or penalty C/m shall automatically be written off.

Game Length

56. a) A game shall be of **25 points or eight boards**. The player who reaches 25 points first, or leads at the conclusion of the eighth board, wins the game.

b) Up to and including the pre-quarter finals, each game is decided on the basis of **eight boards**. If the score is equal at the end of the eighth board, an **extra board** is played. Before the extra board, there shall be a toss to choose break only.

57. All matches shall be decided by the **best of three games**.

Change of Sides

Format

When sides change

Singles Opposite direction at the conclusion of each game

Doubles Next right-hand side at the conclusion of each game

60. a) In the **third game** for matches up to and including pre-quarter finals, sides change after the fourth board, or after any player or pair has scored **13 points** — whichever is earlier.

b) From **quarter-finals onwards**, sides change only after 13 points have been scored by any player or pair.

c) If the change of sides remains unnoticed by the Umpire or any player, it takes place as and when noticed — but after completion of that particular board.

61. The players shall not take more than **two minutes** to change sides.

Chapter 6 — Fouls, Overboard, and Penalties

This is the longest chapter of the Laws. It covers what counts as a foul, what happens when coins leave the playing surface, and the elaborate system of Dues and Penalty coins. If a board ever turns contentious, the

answer is almost always in this chapter.

Foul

62. Any act of violation of the Laws — or anything done contrary to what is stated specifically or implied in these Laws — shall be broadly classified as a foul. Two kinds of foul are recognised:

Technical Foul

Committed *before* the first stroke of the player's turn, or by the player presently *not having* his turn. Penalty:

one C/m of the offender is brought out for placing. The turn continues.

Foul

Committed during or after the first stroke of the player's turn. Penalty: **one C/m** is brought out for placing,

and the **turn is lost**.

Beginner's guide — common fouls

Most everyday fouls cost you **one coin returned to the board** and you **lose your turn**:

- Pocketing the **striker**, or knocking the striker or any coin off the board
- Pocketing an **opponent's coin** — if you had covered the Queen, she is also returned
- Pocketing your **last coin before the Queen** is pocketed and covered — two coins come back
- Touching any coin other than the striker with your hand during a stroke

A **technical foul** (before your stroke, or when it is not your turn) also brings one coin out, but you keep your turn. See Rules 62–64 for the full list.

64. b) While pocketing the C/m and/or Queen, if a Foul is committed, the number of C/m and/or Queen pocketed with an additional C/m shall be brought out for placing and the turn of the player shall be lost.

C/m Overboard

When coins or the Queen jump off the playing surface, the Umpire restores them according to a precise priority.

65. a) A jumped C/m and/or Queen is placed by the Umpire in the **Centre Circle**, if space permits — covering it fully or to the maximum extent possible.

b) **If both the Queen and a c/m jump in the same stroke** — the Queen is placed first; the jumped c/m is placed touching the Queen, in the opposite direction of the player presently having his turn.

c) **If both white and black c/m jump in the same stroke** — preference is given to place the c/m of the player who made that stroke first; the other c/m is placed touching the first c/m as in 65(b).

d) **If more than 2 c/m jump in the same stroke** — the first 2 are placed per 65(b) and 65(c). The rest are placed touching the first 2, as far as possible.

66. a) If c/m and/or Queen jump out and fall back on the playing surface, they are placed by the Umpire in the Centre Circle. Any disturbed c/m are corrected by the Umpire at his discretion.

b) However, if c/m fall back on the playing surface after hitting the **shade, bulb or light fittings**, the travel is considered natural. Disturbed c/m shall not be rearranged.

C/m Rolling and Overlapping

67. If a c/m and/or Queen stands on its rim, it shall be allowed to remain as it is.

68. If two C/m and/or Queen overlap each other, they shall be left undisturbed.

69. a) If the Striker rests on c/m and/or Queen, the Striker is removed without disturbing them. If disturbed, the original position is restored by the Umpire as far as possible.

b) If this happens at the mouth of a pocket and, during removal of the Striker, the C/m and/or Queen lose their centre of gravity and fall into the pocket, they are **deemed pocketed**.

70. a) If C/m and/or Queen rest **on** the Striker, the Striker is removed by the Umpire by lifting the C/m and/or Queen and replacing them where they would rest if the Striker were not there.

b) If at the mouth of a pocket and, during removal of the C/m/Queen, the Striker loses its centre of gravity and falls into the pocket, the Striker is deemed pocketed and a Due is declared.

71. If a C/m resting perilously at the mouth of the pocket actually falls into the pocket for any reason, it shall be considered to have been properly pocketed.

Dues and Penalties

The Due system administers what happens when a player pockets the Striker, or pockets coins improperly. The general rule: a proper stroke that goes wrong costs **one coin** (a Due); an improper stroke costs **two coins** (Due + Penalty).

Pocketing the Striker

Situation	Stroke type	Consequence
Striker alone	Proper	Turn lost, 1 C/m taken out as Due
Striker alone	Improper	Turn lost, 2 C/m taken out (Due + Penalty)
Striker + own C/m	Proper	Pocketed C/m + 1 Due C/m out for placing; turn continues
Striker + opponent's C/m	Proper	Opponent's C/m stays pocketed; 1 Due out; turn lost
Striker + own + opponent's C/m	Proper	Own C/m + 1 Due out; turn continues
Own C/m pocketed	Improper	C/m + Penalty C/m out; turn lost
Own C/m + Striker	Improper	C/m + 2 C/m (Due + Penalty) out; turn lost
Opponent's C/m pocketed	Improper	Stays pocketed; Penalty C/m out; turn lost

72. c) If a Due/Penalty becomes payable before any of the player's C/m have been pocketed, it remains outstanding and is taken out as soon as available.

Placing Due and Penalty Coins

78. a) Due or penalty C/m shall be taken out for placing immediately after being available — but only after the completion of the stroke (though it may be during the turn of the same player).

b) **In doubles** — the Due and/or penalty C/m is always taken out for placing by the player sitting to the **right hand side** of the player having his turn. Exception: if the player pockets the opponent's C/m and the Due/Penalty becomes available, the player himself takes out the C/m for placing.

79. If a Due/Penalty is available for placing but there is not enough space, the player is permitted to place it immediately after space becomes available.

80. If space is available but the player does not desire to risk a Foul, he loses his chance to place and his claim for placing stands forfeited.

84. a) **Placing is considered complete** once the finger is removed from the C/m, provided the C/m is inside the Outer Circle.

b) Holding any other C/m or the striker while placing is **not permitted**.

85. If a player places or moves the Due/Penalty away from the Outer Circle, he is asked to place it inside. A Foul is declared.

86. The placing must not disturb any other C/m or the Queen. If it does, the Umpire replaces them in the original position and a Foul is declared.

Forgo the Due

A player may choose to forgo the Due and/or penalty C/m **in total only**, not partially. The decision must be communicated to the Umpire within **15 seconds**, failing which the right to place is forfeited (Rule 87).

88. a) The time limit for placing Due/Penalty C/m is **15 seconds** after the Umpire's announcement.

b) If placing is not completed within the period, the C/m already placed may be ordered to be removed and a foul declared against the offender.

89. a) Due and Penalty C/m **cannot be set off against each other**.

b) Due and Penalty C/m shall not be placed covering the Centre Circle wholly or partially. If placed, the player is asked to rectify. A Foul is declared.

90. In doubles, a player shall not take out the penalty/Due C/m for his partner. If his partner doesn't find the required C/m in adjoining pockets, he shall request the Umpire to provide the correct colour and number.

91. During the course of the board, if a player **gets up from the seat** during his or his opponent's turn, for any reason, he loses the board by the number of his C/m and/or Queen lying on the board. If the opponent's score is 22 or more, he loses by the number of C/m only.

Chapter 7 — The Queen

The Queen is the red coin in the centre of the board and the centrepiece of carrom strategy. She's worth 3 points — but only if "covered" by one of your own coins on the same or the next stroke. This chapter covers every situation involving the Queen.

Pocketing and Covering

The covering rule

A player may pocket the Queen only after at least one of his own C/m has already been pocketed. To **cover** the Queen, he must pocket one of his own C/m in the same stroke or the immediately following stroke.

If you pocket the Queen **before** any of your own coins, or without covering her on the next shot, the Queen is taken out and placed in the centre — you lose your turn. A board cannot end while the Queen is still on the table; she must be pocketed and covered by the winner.

93. The Queen shall be placed by the Umpire only in the Centre Circle. If a shot is automatically formed when placed, it cannot be altered.

94. If the Centre Circle is partially or completely covered by other C/m, the Queen is placed so as to occupy most of the uncovered portion, or in any position adjacent to the Centre Circle in such a way that it is not easy for the player having his turn to pocket. **The Umpire's placement decision is final.**

95. a) If the Queen is pocketed before any of the player's own C/m, the Queen is taken out for placing and the player loses his turn.

b) If the Queen is pocketed while there is a Due against the player, the Queen is taken out for placing and the player loses his turn.

c) **However**, if after recovery of Due/Penalty all nine of the player's C/m are still on the C/B, he has the right to pocket and cover the Queen.

d) If, at the break or in a subsequent stroke when all nine C/m are on the C/B, the Queen is pocketed along with the Striker, the Queen is taken out for placing and a Due is declared. The player loses his turn.

96. If the Queen is pocketed by a stroke and is not covered, the Queen is taken out for placing. If not noticed by the Umpire or the opponent before the next stroke is made, the Queen is recorded as properly covered.

97. a) **Queen + one of your C/m pocketed together** — the Queen is considered covered.

b) However, at the Break (or any stroke when all nine of your C/m are on the C/B), if **only one** of your C/m and the Queen are pocketed together, you must still cover. If **more than one** of your C/m and the Queen are pocketed together, the Queen is considered covered.

When the Queen and Striker Meet

The most error-prone situations: the player pockets the Queen together with the Striker, and/or with one or more own C/m. Here's the matrix.

Pocketed together	Stroke type	Queen	Penalty	Turn
Queen + Striker	Proper	Taken out for placing	+1 C/m	Continues

Pocketed together	Stroke type	Queen	Penalty	Turn
Queen + Striker	Improper	Taken out for placing	+2 C/m	Lost
Queen + own C/m + Striker	Proper	Out for placing	+1 Due C/m	Continues
Queen + own C/m + Striker	Improper	Out for placing	+2 C/m (Due + Penalty)	Lost

100. a) **While covering the Queen**, if the Striker alone is pocketed by a proper stroke — the Queen is taken out for placing, a C/m is taken out as Due, the turn is lost.

b) Same, by an improper stroke — Queen taken out for placing, **two** C/m taken out (Due + Penalty), the turn is lost.

101. a) **While covering the Queen** by a proper stroke, if the player pockets the Striker along with his own C/m — the C/m is taken out plus 1 Due. The player **continues** his turn. If, in the subsequent stroke, no C/m is pocketed, the Queen is **not** considered covered and is taken out for placing.

b) Same, by an improper stroke — C/m + 2 (Due + Penalty) out; turn **lost**; Queen taken out by Umpire.

Endgame Scenarios

The remaining 13 rules (102–114) cover edge cases where the last C/m of either player, the Queen, and the Striker all interact. The principle is consistent: a *proper* stroke scores or loses by the **value on the board** (C/m + Queen if applicable); an *improper* stroke triggers an extra penalty on top.

102. Player pockets his last C/m and the opponent's last C/m together while covering the Queen:

- Proper: he wins by 3 points (1 point if at 22+).
- Improper: opponent wins by 3 points (1 if at 22+). One additional point if demanded.

103. Player pockets only the opponent's last C/m while covering the Queen:

- Proper: he loses by the number of his C/m on the C/B plus the Queen's points (or just by C/m if opponent at 22+).
- Improper: same, plus an additional point to the opponent if demanded.

104. Queen + own last C/m + opponent's last C/m pocketed together:

- Proper: the player wins by 3 points (1 if at 22+).
- Improper: opponent wins by 3 points (1 if at 22+), plus one additional if demanded.

105. Own last C/m + opponent's last C/m together, Queen still on the C/B: opponent wins by 3 points (1 if at 22+) regardless of stroke type. Improper adds an additional point if demanded.

106. Opponent's last C/m alone, Queen still on the C/B: player loses by his C/m on the board + Queen value (or just by C/m if opponent at 22+). Improper adds an additional point if demanded.

107. Player pockets his own last C/m, leaves the Queen on the C/B: player loses by 3 points (1 if opponent at 22+). Improper adds one if demanded.

108. Own last C/m + Striker, Queen still on the C/B: lose by 3 points (1 if opponent at 22+). Improper: opponent gets 2 additional if demanded.

109. Queen + own last C/m + opponent's last C/m + Striker, all together: player loses by 3 points (1 if opponent at 22+). Proper stroke: +1 additional if demanded. Improper: +2 additional if demanded.

110. Own last C/m + opponent's last C/m + Striker, Queen already covered by player: lose by 1 point. Proper: +1 additional if demanded. Improper: +2 additional if demanded.

111. Opponent's last C/m + Striker, leaves Queen on C/B: lose by C/m on board + Queen (or just by C/m if at 22+). Proper: +1 for the Striker if demanded. Improper: +2 if demanded.

112. Own last C/m + opponent's last C/m + Striker, Queen already covered by opponent: player loses by 3 points (gets 1 if opponent at 22+). Proper: +1 additional if demanded. Improper: +2 if demanded.

Final Queen Rules

113. If the Queen rests perilously at the mouth of a pocket and actually falls in for any reason, she is considered to have been (duly) pocketed.

114. A player **shall not use a Due or Penalty C/m to make a shot with the Queen**. If used, the Umpire asks him to rectify. A Foul is declared.

Chapter 8 — General Rules and Match Loss

The remaining laws — covering equipment changes during a match, timing, powder etiquette, and the offences that can cost a player the entire match.

Equipment During Play

115. A stroke shall be taken by means of a **Striker only**. The Striker is brought by the player and certified by the Chief Referee or Umpire before play.

116. While taking a stroke, if the Striker jumps over the C/B, the turn of the player continues if he pockets his own C/m and/or Queen in that stroke.

117. A changed new Striker, duly approved by the Chief Referee or Umpire, is allowed in a match **after the particular Board is completed**. If the Striker is damaged mid-board, it may be changed **only after completion of that particular stroke**.

118. a) Once set, the position of the C/B shall not be changed in the middle of the match.

b) The sole authority to make any change after examination, on an appeal by any player, lies with the Umpire.

119. The C/B, table or stand on which the C/B is placed can be changed only after the completion of a Board. The sole authority for deciding the condition of the C/B, stand or table rests with the Umpire.

120. Any damaged C/m, if appealed for replacement, shall be replaced by the Umpire in the original position of the damaged C/m as far as possible.

Time and Appeals

121. a) The time count **stops** when there is an appeal to the Umpire during play. Play shall not continue unless the Umpire has ordered *Play*.

b) The player who violates this loses the entire board by the number of his C/m on the C/B with the Queen's points (if she is on the C/B).

Powder

Powder rules

The powder must be applied evenly by the player having the turn, before the break — neither excessive nor scanty.

122. b)

- (i) The powder shall **not** be applied or removed after the Umpire has announced *Play*.
- (ii) Any wilful attempt to remove or wipe powder from the playing surface is **not** permitted.
- (iii) The removal of powder by way of blowing, wiping or any other way is **not** permitted. Any infringement above is a Foul.

c) However, **excess powder** along the player's own Base Lines and Base Circles may be removed during

his turn — using the Striker only.

d) The Umpire has the right to control the even application of powder.

e) The Umpire should be requested for removal of dust, insects, etc.

Strokes, Timing, and Score

123. A stroke is considered completed only after the Striker, C/m and/or Queen disturbed by the Striker comes to rest. The Striker shall be removed by the player from the C/B immediately. The Umpire may assist on request.

124. a) As long as a player pockets his own C/m and/or Queen, the time count starts as soon as the stroke is completed.

b) When a player fails to pocket his C/m, the time count for the opponent starts only after the Striker has been removed.

c) A player shall not make the stroke before the opponent picks up his Striker from the C/B.

125. a) When a player pockets the C/m of his opponent knowingly or unknowingly, the Umpire stops the player.

b) If unnoticed, the C/m is considered properly pocketed. The turn is lost as and when noticed.

126. a) Hitting, tapping or disturbing the C/B wilfully or otherwise is a Foul.

b) If done in such a way that rearrangement of the C/m becomes impossible, the offender loses the entire Board by his C/m on the C/B with the Queen's points.

127. a) A stroke is considered made if the Striker slips, leaving any Base Line or Base Circle, regardless of whether it touched any C/m.

b) If the Striker slips but doesn't leave any Base Line/Circle or move any C/m, no stroke is considered made.

128. A player may find out the score from the Umpire only during his turn.

129. A player shall not distract the attention of the opponent by any act.

Striker Position

130. a) The Striker must touch **both Base Lines** when taking a stroke.

b) If the stroke is made from the Base Circle, the Striker must cover the Base Circle fully but **shall not touch the arrow**.

Communication

131. In doubles, during a Board, partners may **not** talk or communicate by gestures. Any violation is a Foul.

132. Players shall not talk to spectators during a game without the permission of the Umpire.

133. A player shall not hold any solid material in either hand, except the Striker, during his turn.

134. C/m and Queen shall **not be moved or disturbed** after the Break except by way of a stroke. If touched, the position is restored by the Umpire and a Foul is declared.

135. The run of the Striker shall **not be tested** on the playing surface during a Board.

136. a) The player shall not keep his Striker on the frame or in the pocket during the board.

b) The Striker may be placed near his base lines while placing a Due or Penalty C/m.

Board Replay and Procedural

137. If players pass over their turn consecutively **3 times each**, that Board is cancelled and replayed.

138. There shall be an interval of **10 minutes** between the second and third games.

139. A player may concede a game and/or match at any stage.

140. In case of unforeseen circumstances beyond the Umpire's control, that Board is replayed.

141. If a C/m is damaged by a stroke, the position of the bigger part of the damaged C/m is considered for all purposes; the Umpire's decision is final.

142. If a C/m lies on the Base Lines or Base Circles preventing a player from taking a stroke for want of space, that board is replayed.

Loss of Entire Match

Grounds for losing the entire match

Rule 143 lists nine conduct breaches serious enough that a player loses the match outright, not just a board.

143. A player shall lose the entire match for any act of indiscipline and/or any of:

- a. Leaves the match board area (10 square feet) during the game without the Umpire's permission.
- b. Fails to abide by the time limit given for the rest in the deciding game.
- c. Refuses to abide by the decision of the Umpire and/or Chief Referee.
- d. Passes insulting remarks against the Umpire, Chief Referee or authorities — before, during, or immediately after the match.
- e. Smokes or smells Foul while at play due to intoxicating drinks, and/or is under the influence of drugs.
- f. Plays with an uncertified Striker.
- g. Discontinues play during a match without the Umpire's permission.
- h. Disturbs or distracts the opponent more than twice, despite the Umpire's warning.
- i. Fails to report to the Umpire at his match Board within **15 minutes** after the match is announced.